

ECON 1550 International Finance

A Tour of the World

Agenda

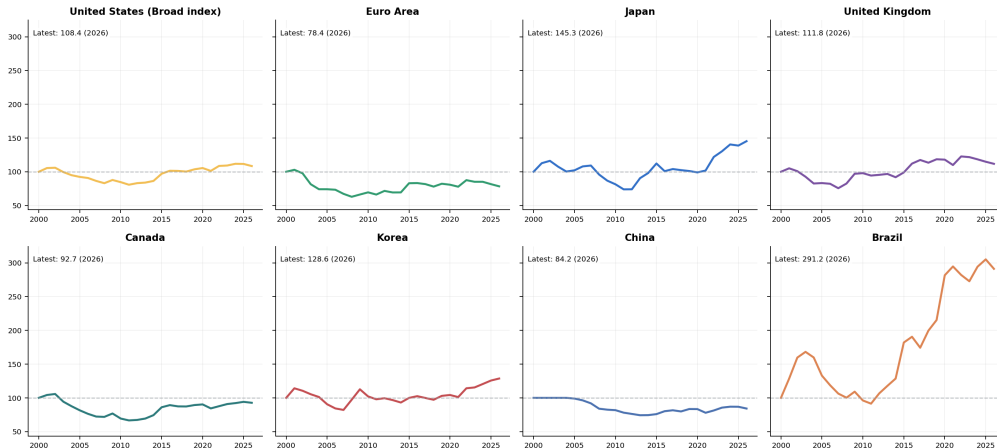
- Long-run and recent exchange-rate behavior
- Aggregate stock-market performance and current yield curves
- Growth, inflation, and unemployment across major economies
- Where the post-2020 cycle looks global and where it does not

How to read the figures

- Coverage: U.S., euro area, Japan, U.K., Canada, Korea, China, and Brazil.
- Exchange-rate and stock-market panels are indexed to 100 at the start of each window.
- Higher exchange-rate values always mean a stronger dollar; the U.S. panel uses a BIS broad dollar index.
- Recent macro slides combine IMF actual data and IMF outlook years.
- The yield-curve slide is a current snapshot; the euro-area panel uses Germany as a proxy.

Nominal exchange rates: 2000-now

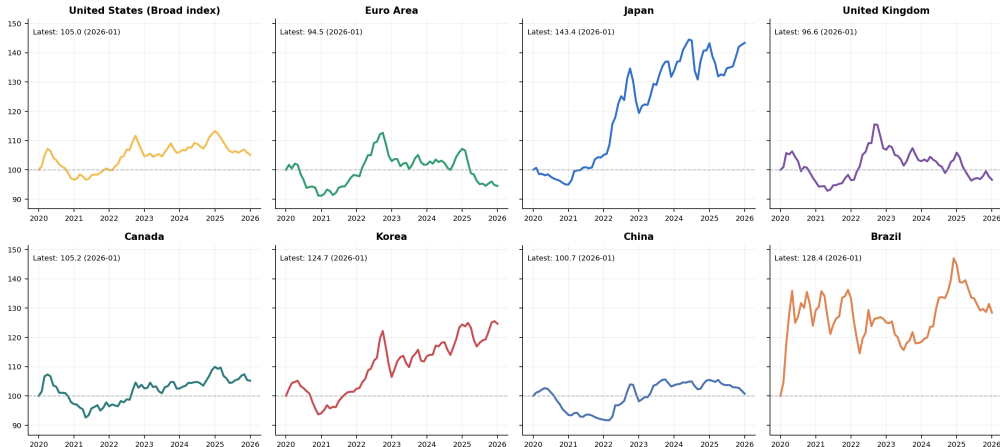
Nominal Exchange Rate Index, 2000-now



Source: [FRED](#) public monthly FX series. Non-U.S. panels plot local-currency units per dollar; the U.S. panel uses BIS broad dollar indexes.

Nominal exchange rates: 2020-now

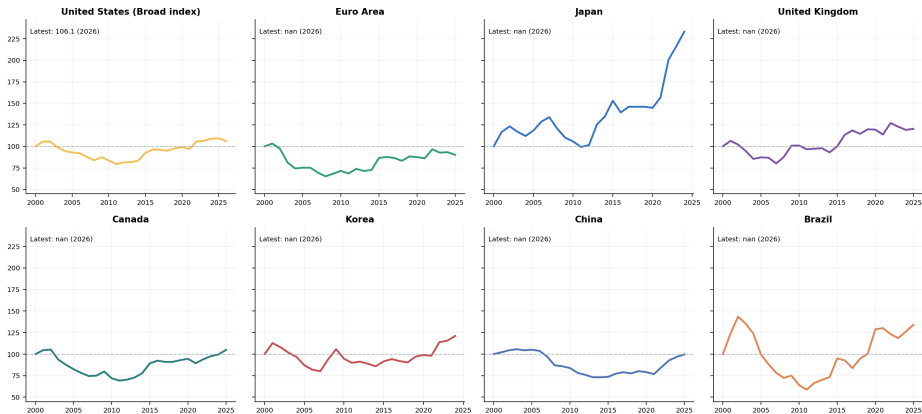
Nominal Exchange Rate Index, 2020-now



Source: [FRED](#) public monthly FX series. Non-U.S. panels plot local-currency units per dollar; the U.S. panel uses BIS broad dollar indexes.

Real exchange rates: 2000-now

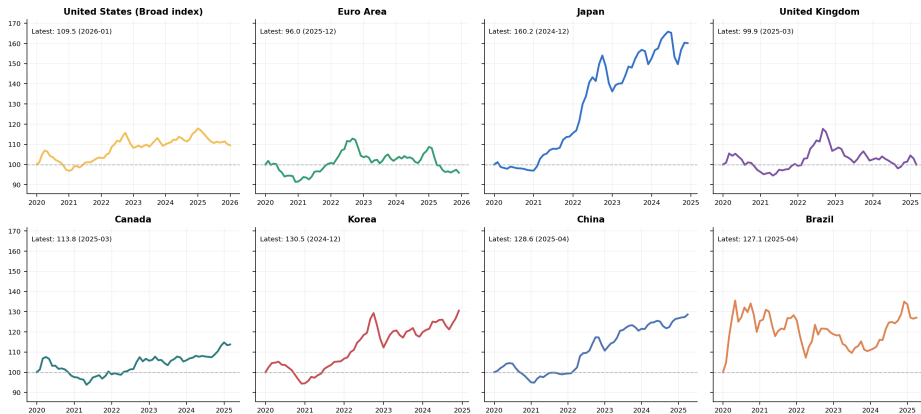
Real Exchange Rate Index, 2000-now



Source: [FRED](#) public monthly FX and CPI series. Japan and Korea use IMF-extended CPI tails through the latest actual inflation year because the FRED CPI endpoints stop early.

Real exchange rates: 2020-now

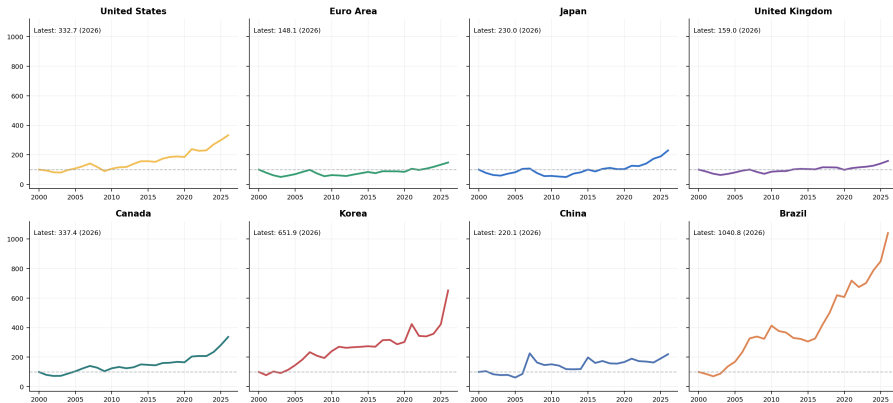
Real Exchange Rate Index, 2020-now



Source: [FRED](#) public monthly FX and CPI series. Japan and Korea use IMF-extended CPI tails through the latest actual inflation year because the FRED CPI endpoints stop early.

Aggregate stock-market performance: 2000-now

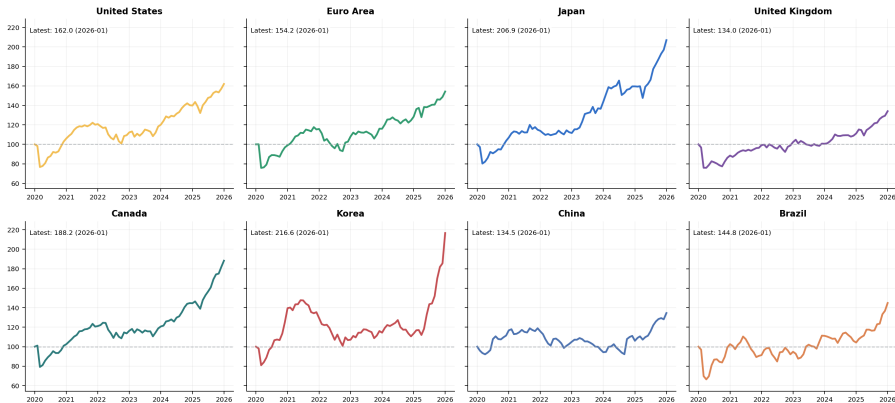
Aggregate Stock-Market Index, 2000-now



Source: [FRED](#) public OECD share-price indexes. Panels are indexed to 100 at the start of each window.

Aggregate stock-market performance: 2020-now

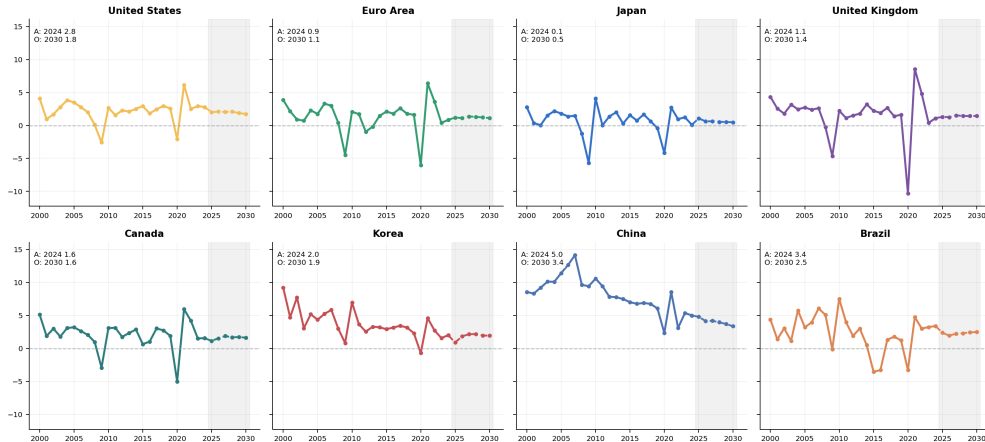
Aggregate Stock-Market Index, 2020-now



Source: [FRED](#) public OECD share-price indexes. Panels are indexed to 100 at the start of each window.

Real GDP growth: 2000-now

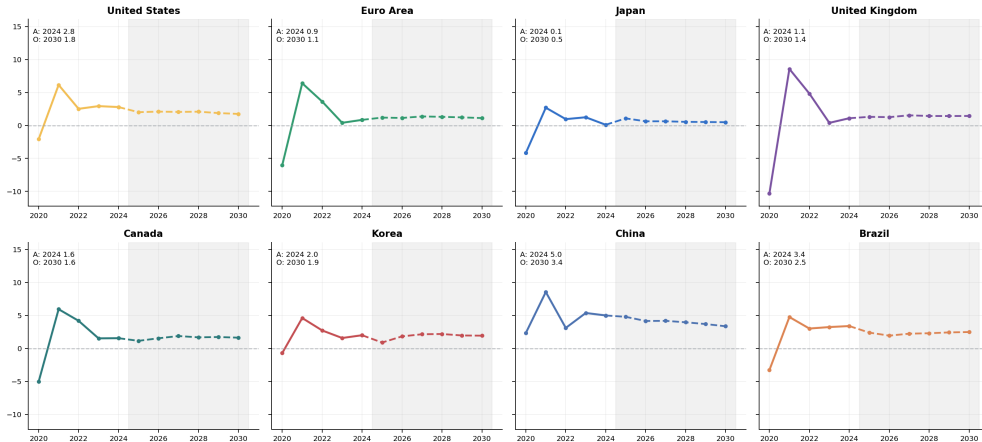
Real GDP Growth, 2000-now



Source: IMF World Economic Outlook, October 2025. Gray shading marks estimate/projection years.

Real GDP growth: 2020-now

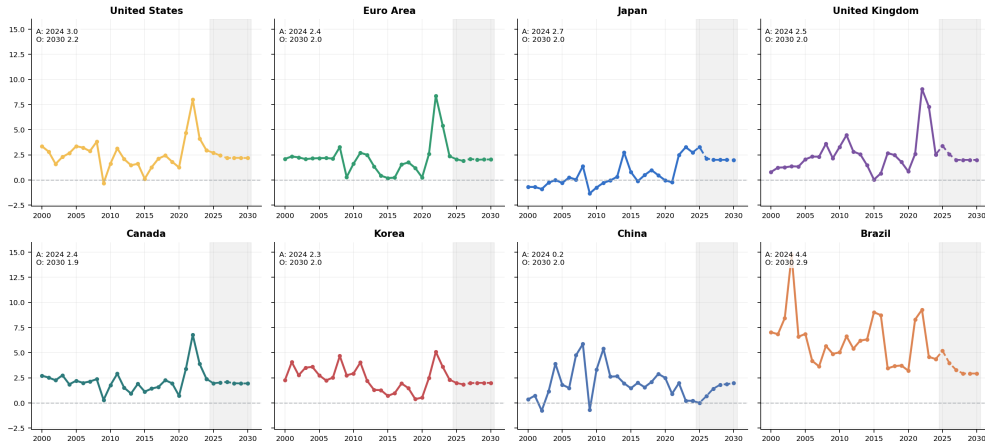
Real GDP Growth, 2020-now



Source: IMF World Economic Outlook, October 2025. Gray shading marks estimate/projection years.

Inflation: 2000-now

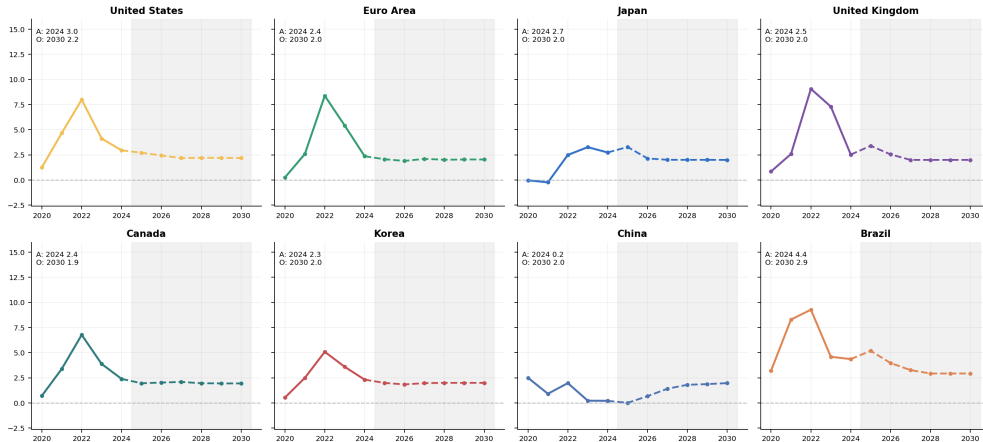
Inflation, 2000-now



Source: IMF World Economic Outlook, October 2025. Gray shading marks estimate/projection years.

Inflation: 2020-now

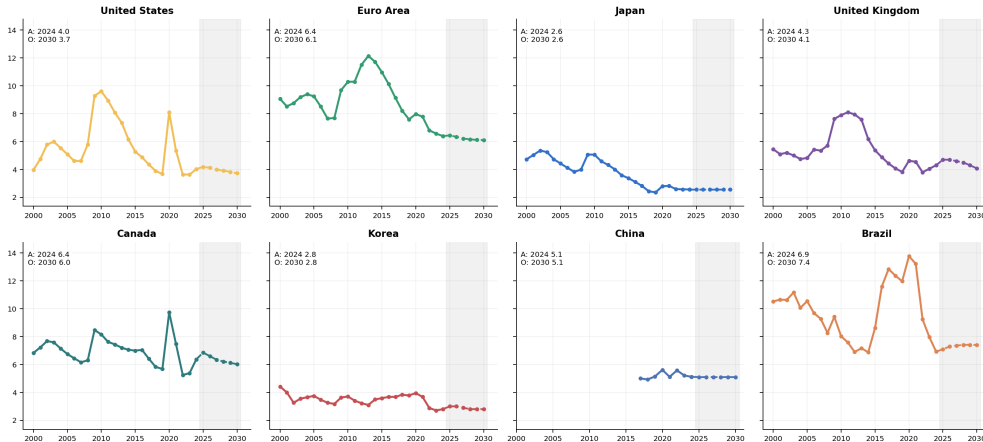
Inflation, 2020-now



Source: IMF World Economic Outlook, October 2025. Gray shading marks estimate/projection years.

Unemployment: 2000-now

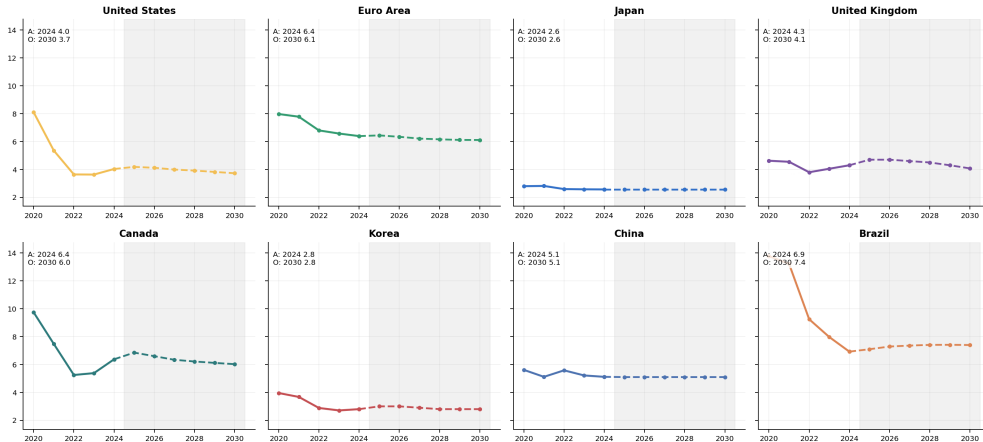
Unemployment, 2000-now



Source: [IMF World Economic Outlook, October 2025](#). Gray shading marks estimate/projection years.

Unemployment: 2020-now

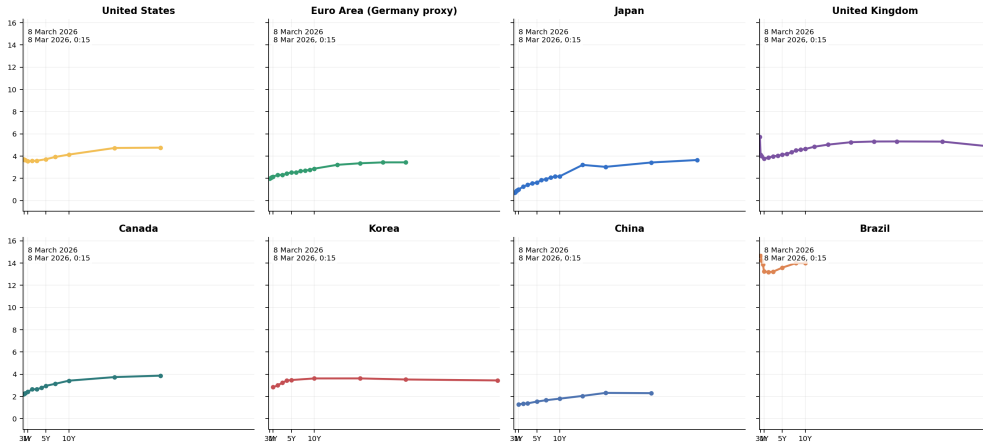
Unemployment, 2020-now



Source: [IMF World Economic Outlook, October 2025](#). Gray shading marks estimate/projection years.

Current yield curves

Current Government Yield Curves



Source: [WorldGovernmentBonds](#) current country yield-curve pages. Snapshot date is shown in each panel; the euro-area panel uses Germany as a proxy.

Snapshot: 2020, latest actual, and latest IMF outlook

Real GDP Growth (%)

Unit	2020	A	O
US	-2.1	2.8	1.8
EA	-6.0	0.9	1.1
JP	-4.2	0.1	0.5
UK	-10.3	1.1	1.4
CA	-5.0	1.6	1.6
KR	-0.7	2.0	1.9
CN	2.3	5.0	3.4
BR	-3.3	3.4	2.5

A = latest actual, O = last WEO year

Inflation (%)

Unit	2020	A	O
US	1.3	3.0	2.2
EA	0.3	2.4	2.0
JP	-0.0	2.7	2.0
UK	0.9	2.5	2.0
CA	0.7	2.4	1.9
KR	0.5	2.3	2.0
CN	2.5	0.2	2.0
BR	3.2	4.4	2.9

A = latest actual, O = last WEO year

Unemployment (%)

Unit	2020	A	O
US	8.1	4.0	3.7
EA	8.0	6.4	6.1
JP	2.8	2.6	2.6
UK	4.6	4.3	4.1
CA	9.7	6.4	6.0
KR	4.0	2.8	2.8
CN	5.6	5.1	5.1
BR	13.8	6.9	7.4

A = latest actual, O = last WEO year

A = latest actual year in the October 2025 WEO release. O = the last year in that WEO horizon.

Source: [IMF World Economic Outlook, October 2025](#). Gray shading marks estimate/projection years.

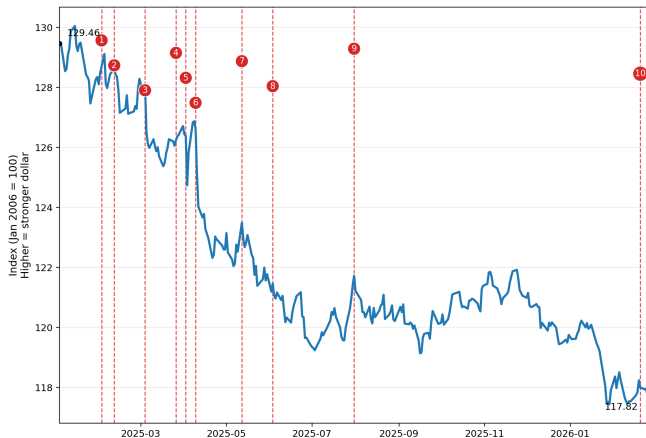
Bottom line to remember

The post-2020 cycle was global across the dollar, equity markets, inflation, labor markets, and the term structure, but the size and persistence of the response still varied a lot across countries.

Exchange rates and policy: current events

Trump tariffs and the broad dollar, 2025–2026

Broad trade-weighted U.S. dollar and major Trump tariff events
Daily Nominal Broad U.S. Dollar Index (DTWEXBGS), Jan 2, 2025 to Feb 27, 2026



Event key

- 1 Feb 1, 2025
25% on Canada/Mexico;
10% on China
- 2 Feb 10, 2025
Steel/aluminum
raised to 25%
- 3 Mar 4, 2025
Canada/Mexico tariffs
take effect; China to 20%
- 4 Mar 26, 2025
25% tariff on imported
autos/light trucks
- 5 Apr 2, 2025
10% baseline tariff +
country-specific duties
- 6 Apr 9, 2025
Most country tariffs paused;
10% blanket stays; China up
- 7 May 12, 2025
U.S.-China 90-day
tariff rollback
- 8 Jun 3, 2025
Steel/aluminum
raised to 50%
- 9 Jul 31, 2025
Tariffs set on 69 partners
(Aug 7 start)
- 10 Feb 20, 2026
Court strikes down IEEPA tariffs;
new temporary duty announced

Timeline of major tariff events

	Date	Event
1	Feb 1, 2025	25% on Canada/Mexico; 10% on China
2	Feb 10, 2025	Steel/aluminum raised to 25%
3	Mar 4, 2025	Canada/Mexico tariffs take effect; China to 20%
4	Mar 26, 2025	25% tariff on imported autos/light trucks
5	Apr 2, 2025	10% baseline + country-specific (“Liberation Day”)
6	Apr 9, 2025	Most country tariffs paused; 10% blanket stays
7	May 12, 2025	U.S.–China 90-day tariff rollback
8	Jun 3, 2025	Steel/aluminum raised to 50%
9	Jul 31, 2025	Tariffs set on 69 partners (Aug 7 start)
10	Feb 20, 2026	Court strikes down IEEPA tariffs; new duty announced

Sources: Reuters timeline of major tariff developments; White House fact sheet for the Feb. 20, 2026 temporary import duty.

The dollar fell despite rising tariffs

- Broad dollar index (DTWEXBGS): 129.46 on Jan 2, 2025 $\rightarrow$ 117.82 on Jan 27, 2026—roughly a 9% depreciation over 13 months.
- Standard textbook logic suggests tariffs should *strengthen* the dollar:
 - Tariffs reduce imports $\Rightarrow$ less demand for foreign currency.
 - Domestic production substitutes for imports $\Rightarrow$ higher demand for dollars.
- Yet the dollar weakened through most of the tariff escalation.

Why might tariffs weaken the dollar?

- Retaliation: trading partners imposed their own tariffs, reducing demand for U.S. exports and dollars.
- Uncertainty: frequent policy reversals (pause, rollback, escalation) reduced foreign appetite for U.S. assets.
- Growth expectations: tariff uncertainty lowered expected U.S. growth, making dollar assets less attractive.
- Institutional confidence: the IEEPA legal challenge (event 10) raised questions about the durability of the tariff regime.
- The exchange-rate effect of tariffs depends on the full general-equilibrium response, not just the direct trade-flow channel.

Tariffs in four numbers: before and after

	Pre-2nd Trump term	Current (Mar 2026)
Tariffs on foreign goods entering the U.S.	2.2%	10.2%
Tariffs on U.S. goods entering other countries	$\approx$ 1.9%	$\approx$ 3.2%

- U.S. import-side: trade-weighted applied rate under the Section 122 surcharge (10% on most imports). Pre-second-term baseline is WTO's 2024 trade-weighted U.S. MFN average.
- Export-side: trade-weighted estimate using 2024 U.S. export shares, partner tariff rates, and still-active retaliation (China's 10% on all U.S. goods, Canada's 25% on autos/steel/aluminum).
- The $\approx$ 1.3 pp increase on the export side comes mainly from Chinese and Canadian retaliation still on the books.

MFN averages vs. effective tariffs

- **MFN average tariff:** unweighted (or trade-weighted) mean across tariff lines that a country applies to all WTO members. Published annually by WTO/ITC/UNCTAD.
- **Effective tariff:** what importers actually pay after special measures (Sections 232, 301), emergency surcharges (Section 122), TRQs, and exclusions.
- The U.S. MFN average is low ($\approx 3.3\%$) and barely changed since 2016.
- But the *effective* tariff on many products is much higher in 2026, because the big changes came through **special measures layered on top of MFN duties**.

MFN tariff averages: pre-Trump (2016) vs. current (2024)

Jurisdiction	2016 (pre-Trump)		2024 (latest WTO)	
	Simple	Tr.-wtd	Simple	Tr.-wtd
United States	3.5	2.4	3.3	2.2
European Union	5.2	3.0	4.8	2.7
China	9.9	4.4	7.6	3.1
Canada	4.1	3.1	3.8	3.4
Mexico	7.0	4.5	7.4	5.4
Japan	4.0	2.1	3.7	1.9
United Kingdom	(in EU)		3.7	3.6
India	13.4	7.6	16.2	12.0
Brazil	13.5	10.4	12.0	8.0
South Korea	13.9	6.9	13.4	8.5
Vietnam	9.6	5.7	9.5	5.1

Source: WTO/ITC/UNCTAD tariff profiles. 2016 baseline from *World Tariff Profiles 2017*; 2024 from latest WTO tariff profile PDFs. Trade-weighted 2016 column uses 2015 imports. Simple = unweighted HS-6 average; Tr.-wtd = trade-weighted average. All figures are percentages.

U.S. effective tariffs, March 2026

- For many imports, the tariff bill stacks multiple layers:

$$\text{Effective duty} \approx \underbrace{\text{MFN duty}}_{\approx 3\% \text{ avg}} + \underbrace{10\%}_{\text{Sec. 122}} + \underbrace{\text{Sec. 301}}_{\text{China lists}} + \dots$$

- Section 122 surcharge** (Feb 24–Jul 24, 2026): 10% on all imports except certain critical minerals, energy products, and items already under Section 232.
- Section 232**: steel/aluminum at 50%; autos/parts at 25%. Do *not* stack with the Section 122 surcharge.
- Section 301**: product-specific duties on Chinese imports (on top of MFN and Sec. 122).
- IEEPA tariffs**: struck down by Supreme Court on Feb 20, 2026; no longer in effect.

Tariffs U.S. exports face in major markets

Partner	Non-agricultural		Agricultural	
	Simple	Tr.-wtd	Simple	Tr.-wtd
European Union	4.5	1.0	higher, varies	
Canada	2.5	1.9	higher, varies	
Mexico	5.6	3.5	higher, varies	
China	6.1	4.0	higher, varies	
United Kingdom	3.0	0.5	higher, varies	

- Agricultural tariffs are generally higher and more complex (TRQs, high peaks) across all partners.
- Retaliatory tariffs (targeted at U.S. products) are product-specific and time-varying—not captured by MFN averages.
- Partners with high MFN averages (India 16.2%, Korea 13.4%, Brazil 12.0%) impose high baseline barriers on U.S. exports even without retaliation.

Trade-weighted tariff rates by economy

Economy	Current		Pre-2025	
	Imposed on imports	Faced by exports	Imposed on imports	Faced by exports
China	4.5%	6.1%	3.0%	2.1%
UK	3.3%	2.1%	3.5%	0.8%
Brazil	9.3%	4.6%	9.3%	3.7%
Germany	2.9%	2.7%	2.9%	1.8%
Japan	2.6%	4.0%	2.6%	2.3%
Thailand	6.0%	2.9%	6.0%	1.4%
EU	2.9%	3.6%	2.9%	1.8%

Sources: [WTO Tariff and Trade Data](#) country profiles (trade-weighted MFN and effective-applied tariffs); [WTO World Tariff Profiles 2025](#) (export-side “applied weighted tariff faced”); U.S. Census Bureau 2024 export shares; CBP guidance on Section 122 (10% surcharge). Germany uses EU customs-union rates as proxy. See appendix for full construction details.

The January 2026 yen episode

- On January 23, 2026, the BOJ held its policy rate at 0.75% but sent a hawkish signal: upgraded growth forecasts, retained hawkish inflation outlook, said it would keep raising rates.
- Simple UIP with E_t in Krugman notation (USD per JPY):

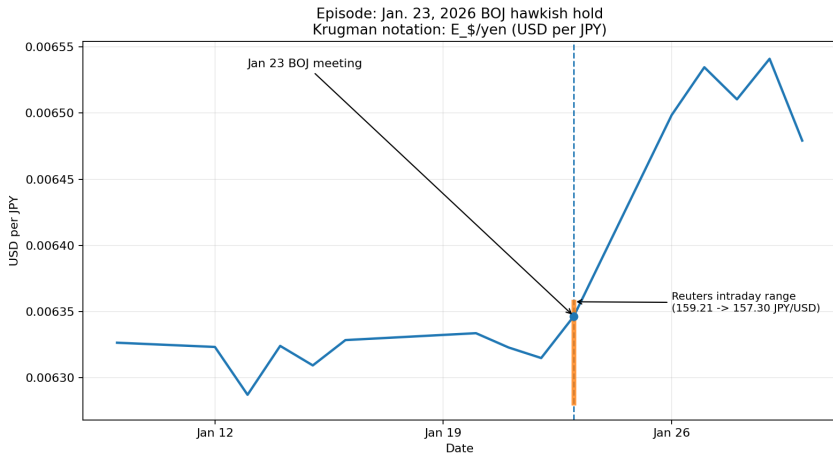
$$E_t = E_{t+1}^e \frac{1 + R_t^Y}{1 + R_t}$$

- Holding E_{t+1}^e and R_t fixed, higher $R_t^Y \Rightarrow$ higher $E_t \Rightarrow$ yen appreciates.

What actually happened on January 23

- During Gov. Ueda's press conference the yen *weakened*: the market quote rose to 159.21 JPY/USD.
- Only later did the yen reverse sharply, reaching about 157.30 JPY/USD.
- The initial move is the opposite of what simple UIP predicts.
- Daily data show net yen appreciation after the meeting, but miss the intraday sign reversal.

Daily exchange rate around the episode



Source: FRED DEXJPUS (daily JPY per USD), converted to USD per JPY. Orange segment: Reuters-reported intraday range (159.21 → 157.30 JPY/USD).

Why simple UIP gets the sign wrong

- The textbook comparative static in $E_t = E_{t+1}^e \frac{1+R_t^Y}{1+R_t}$ holds E_{t+1}^e and the risk premium fixed.
- In practice, all three moved at once on January 23:
 - Markets doubted how much tightening would actually follow.
 - The expected future exchange rate E_{t+1}^e shifted.
 - Intervention risk and fiscal-political constraints mattered.
- Once E_{t+1}^e and risk premia move, the spot rate can go the opposite way.

Bottom line to remember

Simple UIP captures the basic logic—more attractive foreign deposits should strengthen the foreign currency today—but the January 2026 BOJ episode shows that changing expectations, risk premia, and intervention risk can dominate, making the initial market reaction go the wrong way.

Appendix: Exact IDs (1/4)

United States: WEO code USA; nominal FX NBUSBIS; real FX RBUSBIS; CPI CPIAUCNS; stock SPASTT01USM661N; yield slug `united-states`.

Euro Area: WEO code G163; nominal FX EXUSEU, then invert; real FX uses formula on next slide with CPI CP0000EZ19M086NEST; stock SPASTT01EZM661N; yield slug `germany` (Germany proxy).

Japan: WEO code JPN; nominal FX EXJPUS; real FX uses formula on next slide with CPI JPNCPIALLMINMEI; stock SPASTT01JPM661N; yield slug `japan`.

United Kingdom: WEO code GBR; nominal FX EXUSUK, then invert; real FX uses formula on next slide with CPI GBRCPIALLMINMEI; stock SPASTT01GBM661N; yield slug `united-kingdom`.

Appendix: Exact IDs (2/4)

Canada: WEO code CAN; nominal FX EXCAUS; real FX uses formula on next slide with CPI CANCPIALLMINMEI; stock SPASTT01CAM661N; yield slug canada.

Korea: WEO code KOR; nominal FX EXKOUS; real FX uses formula on next slide with CPI KORCPIALLMINMEI; stock SPASTT01KRM661N; yield slug south-korea.

China: WEO code CHN; nominal FX EXCHUS; real FX uses formula on next slide with CPI CHNCPIALLMINMEI; stock SPASTT01CNM661N; yield slug china.

Brazil: WEO code BRA; nominal FX EXBZUS; real FX uses formula on next slide with CPI BRACPIALLMINMEI; stock SPASTT01BRM661N; yield slug brazil.

Appendix: Transformations (3/4)

1. FRED rule: download https://fred.stlouisfed.org/graph/fredgraph.csv?id=SERIES_ID and use the monthly values exactly as returned.
2. Bilateral nominal FX is plotted as local-currency units per dollar: for Japan, Canada, Korea, China, and Brazil use the FRED value directly; for the euro area and U.K. set $E_t = 1/x_t$; for the U.S. use NBUSBIS directly.
3. Bilateral real FX for non-U.S. units is $q_t = E_t \times P_{US,t}/P_{i,t}$, with $P_{US,t} = \text{CPIAUCNS}$ and $P_{i,t}$ from the IDs above; for the U.S. use RUSBIS directly.
4. Long-run FX, real FX, and stock graphs: keep dates from 2000 onward; annualize by arithmetic mean of the 12 monthly observations in each year; plot $100 \times x_t/x_{2000}$.
5. Recent FX, real FX, and stock graphs: keep monthly observations with date $\geq 2020-01-01$; plot $100 \times x_t/x_{base}$, where x_{base} is the first available observation in that window.
6. Macro graphs use raw annual percentages from WEO; no re-scaling, interpolation, seasonal adjustment changes, or other smoothing is applied.

Appendix: Exact Vintage And Adjustments (4/4)

1. IMF rule: use [IMF WEO October 2025](#), exact raw file `overleaf/Data/imf/weo/weo_2025_10_v9_0_0.csv`. Indicator codes are NGDP_RPCH (real GDP growth), PCPIPCH (inflation), and LUR (unemployment). Exact WEO series code is `{country_code}.{indicator}.A`.
2. Projection rule for macro plots: `is_projection = year > LATEST_ACTUAL_ANNUAL_DATA`. Recent macro plots use a solid line through the latest actual year, a dashed line from that same point through the last WEO year, and gray shading from latest actual year + 0.5 to last WEO year + 0.5.
3. CPI extension rule if partner CPI ends before nominal FX ends: extend only through the latest actual inflation year and only with actual WEO inflation. If year y has annual inflation π_y , then monthly extension uses $P_{m+1} = P_m(1 + \pi_y/100)^{1/12}$. In this deck this affects Japan and Korea. No interpolation and no other extrapolation are used anywhere.
4. Yield-curve rule: open <https://www.worldgovernmentbonds.com/country/{slug}/>, extract COUNTRY1, POST it to <https://www.worldgovernmentbonds.com/wp-json/country/v1/main>, and plot the Latest series from mainChart. The exact cross section plotted in this PDF is `Resources/Data/yield_curve_current.csv`; all rows in this file have snapshot date 8 March 2026.
5. Exact transformed inputs used by the figures in this deck are `nominal_exchange_rate_monthly.csv`, `nominal_exchange_rate_annual.csv`, `real_exchange_rate_monthly.csv`, `real_exchange_rate_annual.csv`, `stock_market_monthly.csv`, `stock_market_annual.csv`, `macro_annual.csv`, and `yield_curve_current.csv` in `Resources/Data/`.

Appendix: Tariff table — construction

- **Import-side, current:** latest [WTO](#) country-profile effective-applied tariff when reported; otherwise the latest WTO trade-weighted MFN average.
- **Import-side, pre-2025:** latest official pre-January-2025 WTO trade-weighted MFN average.
- **Export-side, pre-2025:** [WTO World Tariff Profiles 2025](#) summary statistic “applied weighted tariff faced in major markets.”
- **Export-side, current:** pre-2025 WTO number updated by replacing the U.S. component with the verified U.S. Section 122 blanket surcharge (10%), using each economy’s 2024 export share to the U.S. (U.S. Census Bureau). For China, the U.S. effective rate is rounded to 30% because Section 301 and Section 232 tariffs remain in force on top of the surcharge (outside estimates: 30–34%).
- **Cautions:** Germany uses EU customs-union import-side rates and EU export-side numbers as a proxy ([WTO goods schedules](#) treat Germany as part of the EU). Brazil’s current export-side is noisy: some exports are exempt, some face the 10% global tariff, others remain under Section 232.

Sources: [WTO Tariff and Trade Data](#); U.S. Census Bureau 2024 export data; CBP guidance on Section 122.

Appendix: Tariff table — economy details

China: WTO tw MFN 3.0% (2024); effective-applied 4.5% (Nov 10, 2025). Export pre-2025: 2.1%. U.S. export share: 14.7%. [WTO profile](#).

UK: WTO tw MFN 3.5% (2024); effective-applied 3.3% (Jun 30, 2025). Export pre-2025: 0.8%. U.S. export share: 14.1%. [WTO profile](#).

Brazil: WTO tw MFN 9.3% (2024; used for both periods). Export pre-2025: 3.7%. U.S. export share: 12.1%. Current export-side (4.6%) is a closest-comparable aggregate due to mixed U.S. treatment (exempt, 10% global, Section 232). [WTO profile](#).

Germany: EU customs union; import-side uses EU tariff numbers. Export-side pre-2025 uses EU number (1.8%). U.S. export share: 10.4% (Destatis). Read as proxy, not official Germany-only statistic. [WTO goods schedules](#).

Japan: WTO tw MFN 2.6% (both periods). Export pre-2025: 2.3%. U.S. export share: 20.2%. [WTO profile](#).

Thailand: WTO tw MFN 6.0% (both periods). Export pre-2025: 1.4%. U.S. export share: 18.3%. [WTO profile](#).

EU: WTO tw MFN 2.9% (both periods). Export pre-2025: 1.8%. U.S. export share: 20.9%. [WTO profile](#).